Read Words in Context

Vocabulary Words

allowed	hire
dismiss	inexpensive
distracted	inferior
dull	meaningful
focused	misery
forbidden	optimist
frail	pessimist
glistening	pleasure
hardy	senseless
high-priced	superior

Word Learning Tip!

An **antonym** is a word that means the opposite or nearly the opposite of another word. For a pair of words to be true antonyms, they must share the same part of speech. If an unknown word is the same part of speech as a word you know, but seems to mean the opposite, it could be an antonym for the word you know.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Context Clues You can often understand unfamiliar words by studying their context—the words and sentences that surround them. Sentences that compare and contrast often contain antonyms. So look for antonyms, as well as other clues, when you come across an unfamiliar word.

READ!

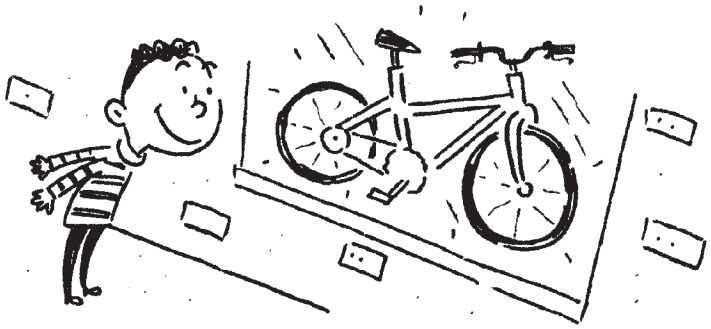
Eyes on the Prize

Christopher wants to buy a **high-priced** bicycle even though he doesn't have much money. He does not want an **inexpensive** model. He believes the cheaper bicycle will be **inferior** to the expensive one. He wants a **superior** machine that will outperform the cheaper models. The bike he wants has a bright, **glistening** finish that makes the lower-priced bicycles look **dull** and colorless. Christopher says, "A top-of-the-line bicycle will give me years of joy and **pleasure**. A low-priced one will bring me trouble and **misery**."

Christopher decides to get a job to earn money to buy the bicycle he wants. There is a problem with his plan, however. Christopher is **forbidden** to work during the week. His parents will not let him work after school. He is **allowed** to work only one day on the weekends. Christopher asks, "Who will **hire** me? If someone does give me a job, they will **dismiss** me as soon as they find someone who can work more days. They will fire me as soon as they get a replacement."

In addition, Christopher looks thin and **frail**. He worries that people will think he is too weak to do hard work, even thought he is really strong and **hardy**.

Yet, Christopher is an **optimist**. He refuses to give up even though there are difficulties in his way. He refuses to be a **pessimist** and lose all hope. He is **focused** on worthwhile goals and will not let himself be **distracted** by **senseless** doubts. He concentrates his energy on **meaningful** work and does not worry about silly things that may never happen. With such an attitude, it won't be long before he will have saved the money he needs to buy his bicycle.



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Connect Words and Meanings

allowed	**focused**	**hardy**	**inferior**	**pessimist**
dismiss	**forbidden**	**high-priced**	**meaningful**	**pleasure**
distracted	**frail**	**hire**	**misery**	**senseless**
dull	**glistening**	**inexpensive**	**optimist**	**superior**

Directions Read the word in the right-hand column. Then find its antonym in the left-hand column. Write the letter of the antonym in the blank beside the word in the left-hand column.

_____	**1.** misery	**A.** dismiss
_____	**2.** high-priced	**B.** superior
_____	**3.** inferior	**C.** pleasure
_____	**4.** hire	**D.** inexpensive
_____	**5.** hardy	**E.** pessimist
_____	**6.** senseless	**F.** distracted
_____	**7.** allowed	**G.** meaningful
_____	**8.** focused	**H.** frail
_____	**9.** dull	**I.** glistening
_____	**10.** optimist	**J.** forbidden



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Connect More Words and Meanings

allowed	focused	hardy	inferior	pessimist
dismiss	forbidden	high-priced	meaningful	pleasure
distracted	frail	hire	misery	senseless
dull	glistening	inexpensive	optimist	superior

Directions Read each definition below. Then write the word in the sentence that best fits the definition.

1. **Definition:** to allow to leave or to let someone go
   Ms. Padma was told to _____ the class early.
2. **Definition:** someone who believes that things will turn out for the best
   Vonda is a(n) _____. Even though the weather report says it will rain on the day of the picnic, she believes the sun will shine.
3. **Definition:** shining in a sparkling way
   Hector stood on the boardwalk and looked at the _____ sand.
4. **Definition:** higher in rank or above average in quality
   The salesperson claimed that the latest laptop computer was _____ to the older model.
5. **Definition:** weak, delicate, light
   After her illness, Marita remained _____ for several weeks.
6. **Definition:** not allowed or approved
   Riding bikes in the park is _____, except on weekends.
7. **Definition:** having meaning and purpose; significant
   From looking at their faces, you could tell that they were having a _____ discussion.
8. **Definition:** a feeling of enjoyment or satisfaction
   Helping my team score during a game gives me a lot of _____.
9. **Definition:**having your thoughts and attention on something else; not concentrating
   The boy had a _____ look on his face. You could tell that he was thinking about a place other than school.
10. **Definition:** not costing a lot; cheap
    She bought an _____ brand of running shoes.

Have a Silent Dialogue Working with a partner, pass a piece of paper back and forth. The first player writes a vocabulary word, the second writes its definition. Next, the first writes an antonym, and the second, a definition of the antonym, and so on, until all the vocabulary words are used.

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Use Words in Context

allowed	focused	hardy	inferior	pessimist
dismiss	forbidden	high-priced	meaningful	pleasure
distracted	frail	hire	misery	senseless
dull	glistening	inexpensive	optimist	superior

Directions There's something wrong with this passage! The boldface words don't make sense in their context. Replace each boldface word with its antonym—the word from the vocabulary list that **does** make sense. Write the correct words in the blanks.

To grow **frail (1)**_____ plants that are strong and healthy, there are several things you must do. First, it's important to stay **distracted (2)**_____ on your goal. Don't let your mind wander! Second, you don't need to buy **inexpensive (3)**_____ plants; low-cost plants work just as well as costly ones. Some people think that expensive plants are **inferior (4)**_____ and better than cheaper ones, but that's rarely true. Next, look for plants that are shiny and **dull (5)**_____, because glossy plants are usually healthier than faded ones. Don't try to take plants from parks and other public places. Often, you are **allowed (6)**_____ by law to remove these plants, and you could get fined. Also, these plants may have bugs than can infect your healthy plants. An insect infestation will bring you much **pleasure (7)**_____, maybe even causing your plants to wilt and die. Even a grouchy **optimist (8)**_____ can become a successful gardener with just a little effort. You don't have to **dismiss (9)**_____ a professional gardener to help you. Gardening is a **senseless (10)**_____ and productive pastime, giving gardeners delicious vegetables, beautiful flowers, and pretty yards!

Write Instructions Think of a goal you would like to reach. For example, your might want to learn a musical instrument, improve in a sport, or get a good grade in mathematics. Then write instructions for reaching that goal. Try to use at least five vocabulary words in your instructions.

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Put Words Into Action

allowed	focused	hardy	inferior	pessimist
dismiss	forbidden	high-priced	meaningful	pleasure
distracted	frail	hire	misery	senseless
dull	glistening	inexpensive	optimist	superior

Directions Write a sentence to answer each of the questions below. Use both words in boldface in your answer.

1. How would an **optimist** and a **pessimist** look at their chances of winning a contest?

_____

2. What can cause a pet to feel **misery** and what might cause a pet to feel **pleasure**?

_____

3. What activity is **forbidden** in the park and what activity is **allowed**?

_____

4. Why might one dog have a **dull** coat and the other a **glistening** coat?

_____

5. In your opinion, what makes one model of bike **inferior** and another **superior**?

_____

6. Why is it important to be **focused** when you do your homework and not **distracted**?

_____

7. What could make an employer **hire** someone, and what could make an employer **dismiss** someone? _____

8. Who would you be more likely to visit in a hospital—someone in **frail** health or someone who is **hardy**? _____

Write Headlines Working with a classmate, write some headlines for a school newspaper story about you or someone you know reaching an important goal. Try to use one or two of the vocabulary words in each of your headlines.

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Review and Extend

allowed	focused	hardy	inferior	pessimist
dismiss	forbidden	high-priced	meaningful	pleasure
distracted	frail	hire	misery	senseless
dull	glistening	inexpensive	optimist	superior

Learn More!

Antonyms can serve as context clues. Antonym clues are words and phrases that help you determine the meaning of an unfamiliar word by understanding what the new word does not mean. Here's an example:

Deserts are **arid** pieces of land with very few *wet* areas.

The word *wet* is an antonym clue that helps make the meaning of **arid** clear. **Arid** means "dry," the opposite of *wet*.

Directions Write a vocabulary word in each blank in the items below. Use the antonym clues in boldface to help you choose the correct word.

1. Staying _____ on your goals helps prevent you from becoming **distracted** and losing your sense of purpose.
2. It is not always true that an **optimist** is more likely to succeed than a _____, because a doubtful person may try harder.
3. Reaching a goal does not guarantee **pleasure**. Sometimes _____ can follow achievement because of the sudden lack of purpose.
4. It is not fair to label some people's goals as **superior** to those of others. What may seem _____ to one person may be of great value to another.
5. If you want to avoid leading a **senseless** life, set _____ goals for yourself and work hard toward achieving them.

Bonus Write a sentence about goals using an antonym pair that was not used above.

_____

Give a Speech Imagine that a friend or relative is receiving an award for a special achievement. Write and present a short speech for the award ceremony. Use all of the vocabulary words you did not use in the activity above.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Choose the word that best fits each sentence below. Write the word in the blank.

1. It's important to stay _____ (*focused, distracted, dull*) when you are studying for a test.

2. They expected a _____ (*hardy, superior, frail*) elderly lady, and so were surprised when the eighty-two-year-old woman skied ahead of them down the slope.

3. The skates were so _____ (*inexpensive, inferior, high-priced*) he thought they would be of poor quality. What a surprise he had when they turned out to be so good.

4. It was a _____ (*glistening, senseless, pessimist*) accident that hurt a lot of innocent people.

5. Don't _____ (*allowed, dismiss, misery*) the idea until you take a few minutes to think about it.

Directions Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that best completes each sentence. Use the clue in boldface to help you choose the correct word.

6. If you are **a person who expects the worst**, you are not an _____.

7. If you **fire** workers during hard times, you just cannot expect to _____ them again when times are good.

8. If you want to make **dull** furniture look _____, use furniture polish.

9. Kelly felt some **pain** when she started exercising after many years. Now she takes _____ in exercising and looking good and being fit.

10. The younger child was upset because her older sister was **permitted** to do things that were _____ to her.

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